

How Google Search Engine Works

We all witness every day how incredibly Google enables us to access a specific piece of information. But do you know how Google is able to offer matching search results out of hundreds of millions of webpages available? Find out

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Search engines serve users with the specific information they are looking for over the Web. These are highly potent tools that offer specific and fast search results to the users by providing information stored on other sites. They offer users high ease to access the Web. The users have to just type in the query regarding the information they are searching for and rest is the work of these search engines to provide the relevant results.

Among a number of search engines available over the Web, Google is the most dominant and the most widely used search engine.

Google search engine is owned by Google Inc. It was originally developed by Larry Page and Sergey Brin in 1997. Every day, over billions of Google hits for searches are reported over the world, which clearly exemplifies the universal popularity of this search engine.

The general appearance of Google home page is shown in Fig. 1. Google has a regular tendency to amaze its users. So quite often it stages unique logos at its home page to honour certain events.

How Google works

There are hundreds of millions of webpages available over the Web, most of which are titled on the whim of their author. Let's see how Google is able to offer incredible search results out of hundreds of millions of webpages available.

Google search engine employs Spider software or Web crawlers to search over the Web (Fig. 2).

The spider software or Web crawler is an automated program that crawls over the Web for information stored on billions of websites and submits the pages to the search engine through links. Googlebot is the spider software that is used by Google search engine.

The search engine starts with a crawler module in which spiders/crawlers or googlebots are sent to the Web to crawl the websites. The spiders start by fetching a few webpages, then they follow the links on those pages and fetch the pages they point to, follow all the



Fig. 1: Google India home page

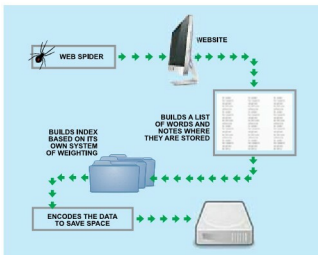


Fig. 2: How spider software works



Fig. 3: What happens when a query is made in the search engine